JACOBY TRANSFERS

ABOUT THE DEALS

You may be either Opener or Responder, but you will always be in the South position.

Feel free to disagree with some of the bids that do not apply directly to Transfers. Deals 9 and 21 for example.

Although it is not included in the Deals you might wish to examine your and dummy's hand and make a Plan of how you would play the contract.

JACOBY TRANSFERS SUMMARY

Created by Oswald Jacoby a lot of years ago, there are two good reasons to use Transfers.

1. They provide a precise bidding method when the Responder to a 1NT opening has a 5 or 6 card Major suit.
2. They make the opening 1NT hand the declarer, keeping the stronger hand concealed.

Jacoby Transfers should only be used in conjunction with the Stayman Convention. The two work smoothly together with Stayman taking care of those hands where Responder has a 4-card Major(s) and Jacoby Transfers taking care of those hands where Responder has a 5- or 6-card Major.

The actual working of transfer bids is simple:
After a 1NT opening a 2♦ response requires Opener to bid 2♥, while a 2♥ response requires Opener to bid 2♠.
On his next bid Responder clarifies the picture by either placing the contract or by inviting Opener to do so.

Jacoby Transfers take much of the guesswork (sometimes called judgement) out of the bidding and steer you directly to these two goals:

1. With a partnership 26 points you will reach game, with 33 you will reach slam.
2. With a partnership 8+ cards in a Major suit you will play in that suit, otherwise you will play notrump.

For the first point consider this table which is based on the 1NT opener holding 15-17 points.

Resp Points	Opener Points			Bidding Target
	15	16	17	
8	23	24	25	Partscore
9	24	25	26	
10	25	26	27	
11	26	27	28	
12	27	28	29	Game
13	28	29	30	
14	29	30	31	
15	30	31	32	
16	31	32	33	
17	32	33	34	Slam
18	33	34	35	

Responder's actions are as follows:

- 8 points or fewer - either pass or transfer and then pass
- 9 points - invite partner to game
- 10 points - either invite or force to game, using your judgement
- 11-15 points - force to game
- 16 points - invite to slam
- 17 points - either invite or force to slam, using your judgement
- 18 points or more - force to slam

Opener's actions are as follows:

- 15 points - decline invitations
- 16 points - either decline or accept, using your judgement
- 17 points - accept invitations

As to the second point above (the 8-card trump fit) you must keep in mind that it is correct to open 1NT with 5-3-3-2 distribution, so it is possible for Opener to have a doubleton in the Major suit that Responder is interested in. Therefore Responder must bid differently with a 5-card suit than he does with a 6-card suit.

- With a 5-card Major Responder transfers Opener to that Major suit, then at his next turn bids notrump.
- With a 6-card Major Responder transfers Opener to that Major suit, then at his next turn rebids the suit.

Opener also has to keep on the right track when Responder has shown only 5 of the suit by rebidding notrump.

- With 2 cards in the transferred suit Opener stays with notrump.
- With 3+ cards in the transferred suit Opener returns to the Major suit.

Some comments are in order about the point count methods used on these pages.

- Initial point count for both hands is based on 4-3-2-1 plus one point for a fifth card in a suit.
- Revalued points (only after a trump fit is discovered) are +1 for a doubleton held by Opener.

- Responder must be very cautious about adding short-suit revalued points. As the long-trump hand Responder will not be able to gain a trick by ruffing since it usually uses a trump which would be a winner anyway.

25 examples will be worth more than another 1000 words.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣8

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦10

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦4

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 5 3
♥ Q 10
♦ Q 6 5
♣ A 7 4 2

♠ Q J 10
♥ 4 2
♦ K J 7 4 3 2
♣ 9 3



♠ 8 7 6 2
♥ A 7 5
♦ A 9
♣ K Q J 10

♠ 9 4
♥ K J 9 8 6 3
♦ 10 8
♣ 8 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥		
All Pass			

2♥ by North
Lead: ♣K

North opens 1NT.

With 6 ♥s of your own you can be sure that your side has at least an 8-card ♥ fit. So playing ♥s will be better than playing notrump. You bid 2♦, transferring partner to ♥s. Partner says 2♥.

Of course you pass. You only have 6 points so there is no chance for game. You just wanted to reach the best partscore and figured 2♥ would be safer than 1NT.

As you can see from partner's hand you made the right call. Played in ♥s your hand will produce five tricks. At notrump your hand will win only one trick if the defenders hold up their ♥A just one time.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 9 2 ♥ K 8 7 6 ♦ 10 9 5 ♣ A 10 5 4	
♠ Q 8 7 6 4 ♥ Q 4 ♦ K 6 3 ♣ J 9 2		♠ K 10 5 ♥ A 5 ♦ Q J 8 4 ♣ K Q 7 3
	♠ A J 3 ♥ J 10 9 3 2 ♦ A 7 2 ♣ 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♠	
All Pass			

3♠ by East
Lead: ♣8

East's 1NT opening shows 15-17 points. What is your bid?

With 9 points you have an invitational strength hand. With a 5-card ♠ suit you should transfer partner to ♠s by bidding 2♥. Partner dutifully responds 2♠.

With this next bid you must tell partner you only have invitational strength, and inform him that you have only 5 ♠s (remember, your transfer promised **AT LEAST** 5). The bid that says both of these facts at once is 2NT. Partner comes back with 3♠. What say you?

You say pass. Partner did not accept your invitation to game so he must have a minimum hand. His correction to 3♠ indicates he has three of the suit and wants to play in ♠s rather than notrump.

You might revalue your hand up to 10 points now that an 8-card fit has been discovered, but it is a really poor 10 points. Also, remember the warning about Responder revaluing for short suits.

As you can see, a 4♠ contract would have no chance, losing 1 trick in each side suit and at least 1 ♠.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ Q J 7 6 4 ♥ 7 4 ♦ K 6 3 ♣ A 9 2	
♠ 2 ♥ J 10 9 8 6 2 ♦ 10 9 7 ♣ 10 8 6	N W E S	♠ A 9 8 3 ♥ K Q 3 ♦ A 5 2 ♣ J 5 4
	♠ K 10 5 ♥ A 5 ♦ Q J 8 4 ♣ K Q 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♦10

A 4♠ contract is definitely the place to be.

South's 1NT opening shows 15-17 points. What is your bid?

With 11 points you are strong enough to force to game. With a 5-card ♠ suit you should transfer partner to ♠s by bidding 2♥. Partner dutifully responds 2♠.

You must make a bid that will force partner to game, but at the same time inform him that you have only 5 ♠s (remember, your transfer promised **AT LEAST** 5). The bid that says both of these facts at once is 3NT. Partner comes back with 4♠. What say you?

You say pass.

You might revalue your hand up to 12 points now that an 8-card fit has been discovered, but with partner's maximum of 17 you are nowhere near slam range.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K 10 8 4 ♥ A J 10 5 ♦ 4 2 ♣ J 10 8	
♠ A J 7 6 ♥ Q 6 ♦ K 7 5 3 ♣ K Q 4		♠ 5 3 ♥ K 9 8 7 4 2 ♦ A 10 6 ♣ 6 5
	♠ Q 9 2 ♥ 3 ♦ Q J 9 8 ♣ A 9 7 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	
All Pass			

3♥ by West
Lead: ♦4

West opens 1NT.

You have 9 points and 6 ♥s. You transfer partner to ♥s by bidding 2♦. He bids 2♥, as instructed.

What is your next bid?

You want to tell partner you have invitational strength. You also want to tell him that you have 6 ♥s, and that the contract must be played in ♥s. The bid that says both is 3♥.

Partner declines your invitation by passing.

A comment is in order about revaluing your hand. Since partner must have at least a doubleton ♥ it is tempting to claim that with the 8-card fit you should add one point for each of your doubletons, bringing your total to 11. If you did this then you should be bidding game rather than just inviting. The problem with the revaluing is that counting doubleton points in the long-trump hand is deceiving. If you do end up ruffing one or both of those suits it will not add any tricks to your total since you would make your small trumps anyway. So when you have a 6-card suit it is more accurate to not revalue.

As you can see, making even 9 tricks is going to be a challenge.